way through Congress, they tried to limit criticism of the US in India. The food minister urged patience in parliament, stressing that, as in India, the bill had to go through a democratic process.[249] Officials also waited to inform the US about the Indian inability to provide troops in Korea until after the passage of the bill.[250] Subsequently, when Washington reacted negatively to India's position on the Japan Peace Treaty, Delhi moderated its response. It also helped temper Rangoon's reaction to American silence about the presence of GMD troops on Burmese territory.[251]

Moreover, in support of India's case for US aid, some Indian commentators laid the groundwork for China-India comparisons. Westerners like Barbara Ward (and later Chester Bowles) had already outlined the idea of the two countries as "laboratories."[252] Frank Moraes, editor of the *Times of India*, elaborated in *Life* magazine in 1951: "China and India are two testing grounds. If India … can assure her people of economic security and individual freedom, Asia will be won for democracy. But if India fails and China succeeds in proving that her present way of life offers food and employment for the millions, Asia will be lost to Communism."[253] Indian officials even employed the "loss" argument in the defense sphere. Officials negotiating for the purchase of tanks and aircraft from the US, for example, noted that it was not in US interest for India to become weak. Washington agreed, approving the sale of 200 Sherman tanks and 54 C-119 transport planes (though India did not eventually purchase that quantity).[254]

Some in the US used the China loss analogy instrumentally to garner support for India, but there were also true believers. Publisher John Cowles noted in *Look* magazine that if the US did not support the stability of the Nehru government in India—"the last important stronghold of democracy in Asia"—it would be a mistake "almost as calamitous as the one we made in China."[255] Spurred by the arguments of Paul Hoffman, director of the Ford Foundation, Bowles also took to making explicit China-India "economic competition" references to lobby for economic aid for India.[256] In a US election year, he further asked legislators to think about the repercussions for the country (and for them) if the US lost India as it had lost China.[257] The ambassador to India wrote to Truman that the loss of India strategically and politically would be even worse because then "Southeast Asia and the Middle East would be impossible to hold."[258]